

CASE ID: 196612710235

EPISODE NAME: 12-3 Incident in Macau (Portugal)

1966/12/03 - 1967/01/29

Sender: China (710)

Target: Portugal (235)

Issue: Improve Human Rights (8)

Final Outcome: Complete Acquiescence by Target to threat (2)

Summary:

On 1966/12/03, the local Chinese population in Macau rioted against Portuguese colonial rule. The government of China threatened sanctions in deploying its army and navy to the borders of Macau. On 1967/01/29, the Macau government caved to the pressure, apologized for the events, increased the role of the Macau Chinese business elite in governance, pledged to never again use force against the Chinese community of Macau, and paid 2 million Macanese pataca in reparations for those injured and killed.

Narrative:

On 1966/11/15, tensions in Macau between the Chinese community and the Portuguese colonial authorities escalated after a dispute over building permits on Taipa Island.¹ On 1966/12/03, riots erupted in Macau against Portuguese rule, emboldened by local communists and pro-China business owners. The rioters ransacked Macau City Hall and the Public Notary's Office, as well as local businesses and organizations aligned with the Republic of China confined to Taiwan.² The government of Macau detained hundreds, injured dozens, and killed several rioters, which angered China.³ On 1966/12/03, the Chinese government threatened unspecific sanctions in deploying the People's Liberation Army to the Chinese-Portuguese Macau border, and in sending four Chinese warships into the waters of Macau, in response to the crackdown and nominally to prevent Red Guards from invading Macau.⁴ Pro-Chinese business owners also refused to pay taxes or sell goods to the Portuguese.⁵

On 1967/01/29, the government of Macau agreed to sign agreements with the Committee of Thirteen (representing the Chinese community in Macau) and the Guangdong Government

¹ Fernandes, Moisés Silva. "Macau in Chinese Foreign Policy during the Cultural Revolution, 1966–1968." *Portuguese Literary and Cultural Studies*, 2010, pp. 209–224. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.62791/wt3y7442>.

² Ibid.

³ Lam, Agnes, and Clayton, Cathryn. "One, Two, Three: Evaluating 'Macao's Cultural Revolution.'" *Modern China Studies*, 2016, 23(2): pp. 163-186.
<https://www.modernchinastudies.org/us/issues/past-issues/123-mcs-2016-issue-2/1413-one-two-three-evaluating-macaus-cultural-revolution.html>.

⁴ Fernandes, Moisés Silva. "Macau in Chinese Foreign Policy during the Cultural Revolution, 1966–1968." *Portuguese Literary and Cultural Studies*, 2010, pp. 209–224. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.62791/wt3y7442>.

⁵ Goodman, Bryna, and Goodman, David. "Twentieth Century Colonialism and China: Localities, the Everyday, and the World." *Taylor & Francis*, 2012, pp. 217-218.
https://www.google.com/books/edition/Twentieth_Century_Colonialism_and_China/wkurNPOgEOkC?hl=en&gbpv=0.

Foreign Affairs Bureau, along with an official statement of apology accepting responsibility for the events.⁶ The government of Macau agreed to increase the role of the Macau Chinese business elite in the Macau government, to never again use force against the Chinese community of Macau, and to pay reparations for the eight dead and 212 injured—a sum of 2 million Macanese pataca.⁷ The de-facto control of China over Macau notably diminished the influence of the Kuomintang (KMT) in Macau.⁸

⁶ Xhu, Chenpin. “【澳门回归20年】回顾“一二·三”反抗殖民血泪史 [Macao's 20 years of reunification] Reviewing the history of ‘One, Two, Three’ resistance to colonial blood and tears”. *Hong Kong News*, https://www.hk01.com/?utm_source=dwnnews&utm_medium=referral.

⁷ Fernandes, Moisés Silva. “Macau in Chinese Foreign Policy during the Cultural Revolution, 1966–1968.” *Portuguese Literary and Cultural Studies*, 2010, pp. 209–224. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.62791/wt3y7442>.

⁸ Cohen, Sam. “Macao Locals Favor Portuguese Rule.” *Sarasota Herald-Tribune*, June 2nd, 1974. https://news.google.com/newspapers?id=_Ug0AAAAIIBAJ&sjid=6GYEAAAAIIBAJ&pg=4785%2C822777.